

— THE LEDGER

CHELSEA'S LONG- CONTRACT TRICK JUST BECAME A TRAP.

Xabi Alonso inherits the bill.

A 5-part breakdown

SWIPE ►►►

0101 / 05

| THE TRICK IS DEAD.

The Premier League and UEFA now cap amortization at 5 years. The 8-year-contract loophole is closed. *Old deals stay grandfathered.*

0202 / 05

| BOOK VALUE BITES.

Amortization leaves a 'book value'. Cucurella's sits near £18m. Sell below it, you book an instant loss. *The trap.*

0303 / 05

| THE 85% WALL.

From 2026/27, wages + fees + amortization can't top 85% of revenue. *No more hiding wages in long deals.*

0404 / 05

| ALONSO'S MANDATE.

New manager. Roughly £100m net to spend.
Every signing needs a sale to match. *Surgery
before shopping.*

0505 / 05

| THE SQUEEZE, IN ONE LINE.

Amortization costs are climbing toward the 85% ceiling. *Sell well, or the window stalls.*

— THE TAKEAWAY

WHO GOES **FIRST?**

Save this before the window. Can Chelsea clear the high-book-value names, or does it stall Alonso's start? Tell us — follow @thearchv_ca.

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